

MAL — Marketing Strategy One-Pager

Consolidated from SVP Marketing & Founder Strategy Sessions | 25 Products | Retail + SME | 18 Markets

Prepared: June 2025
Status: Pre-License / Pre-Launch
License ETA: Sep 2025
Launch Event: Oct 10, 2025
First Products Live: Jul 2026

1M

Waitlist Users (Global)

500K

SMEs (within 2mo of waitlist)

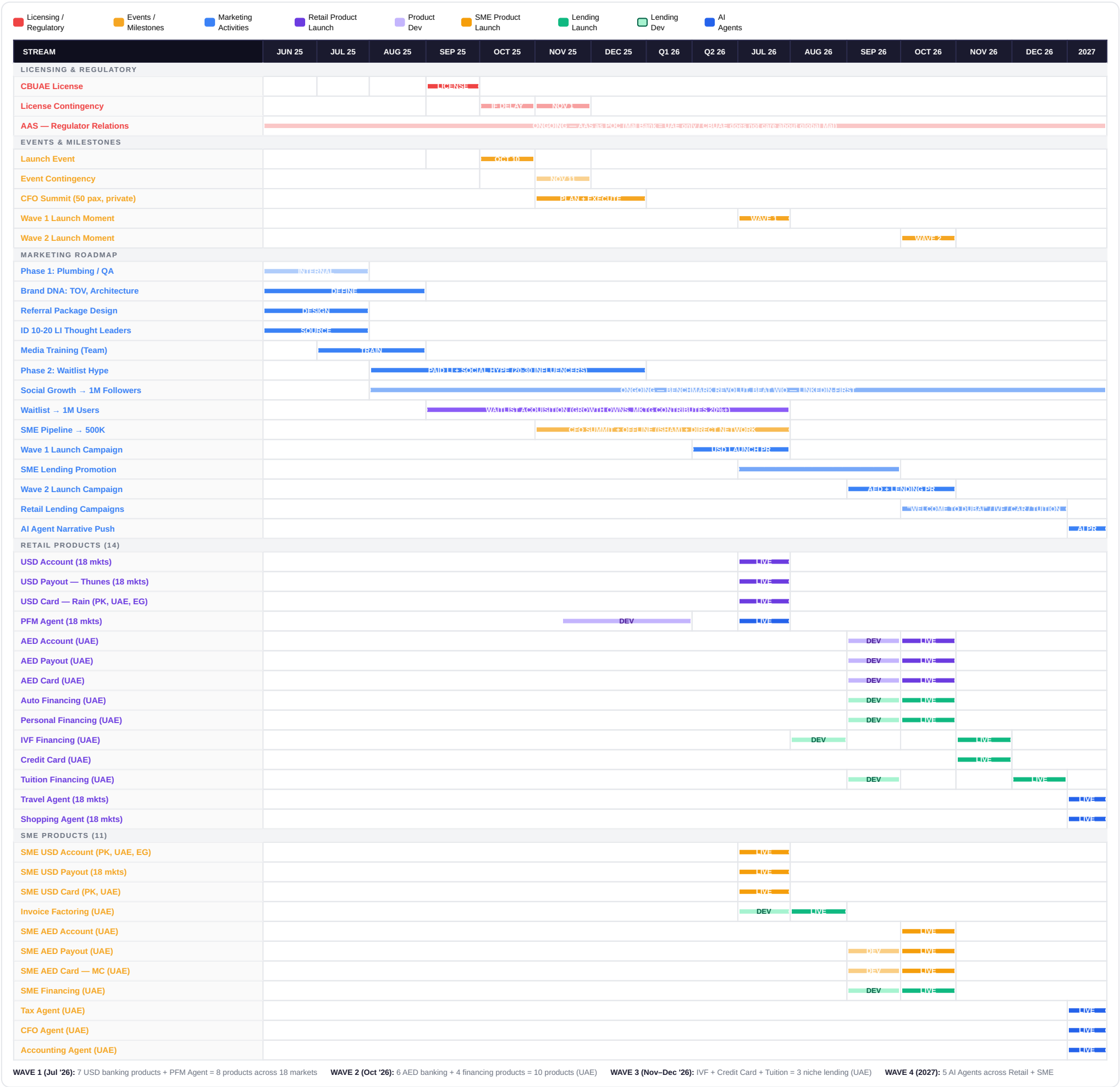
1M

Social Followers (Roadmap)

20%+

Mktg Contribution to Growth

1 UNIFIED MASTER TIMELINE — PRODUCT x MARKETING x LICENSING



2 POSITIONING & OWNERSHIP SPLIT

POSITIONING PYRAMID (PRIORITY ORDER)

LICENSED FINANCIAL INSTITUTION

"Clearly a bank — a full bank with a license" **P0 LEAD**

AI-NATIVE BANKING

"Open an account in 30 seconds — new generation" **P1 DIFFERENTIATOR**

ISLAMIC & SHARIAH-COMPLIANT

"Ethical banking as the added value layer" **P2 CHERRY ON TOP**

Global by Default: AI-native = global. First product = US (ACH/USD). Mal (global) ≠ Mal Bank (UAE/CBUAE). AAS = primary POC for Public Affairs.

MOAT GAP: "Only moat is user-base; everything else is replicable." No unique claim text yet. Must be quantitative. Study Brave's marketing approach.

OWNERSHIP MATRIX

BUDGET ALLOCATION

GROWTH — 80%

BRAND & MKTG — 20%

Budget: Amine | Growth strategy: Mukund | Hiring: Sama

DOMAIN	OWNER	SCOPE
Growth	Mukund	Userbase, retention, referral economics, acquisition (80%)
Marketing	Manar, Yasmeen, Isham	Brand, PR, influencers, events, social, TOV, content
Sales / SME	SME Team + Isham	Offline onboarding, CFO Summit, distribution, pipeline
Product	David, VK, Manar	Demos, tech comms, launches
Public Affairs	AAS	CBUAE comms (UAE-only)
Compliance	Maen + Walid	Risk, regulatory readiness

Rule: Mktg does NOT own growth metrics but must contribute 20%+ to growth. Every \$ ties to a measurable growth metric.

3 INCENTIVE STRATEGY BY SEGMENT

SEGMENT	HOOK	INCENTIVE	PRODUCT ANGLE	CHANNEL	KEY MESSAGE	TIED TO PRODUCT WAVE
Window Shoppers	"Join waitlist, get paid"	Cash for signup; share on LI/IG/X → \$X	Waitlist referral virality	Social, Paid LI	Incentive-driven	Pre-Wave 1
Adopters	"Try the tech first"	Founder Card + 1-yr sub + beta + community	UI, speed, process quality	LI Thought Leaders	"5 slots to give"	Pre-Wave 1
Retail	"Never need SWIFT again"	4x salary on opening; car loan 2 min; student loans	Expats, ACH/USD for EG/TR/IN/PK	Partnerships	"Welcome to Dubai"	Wave 1 USD AED+Lending Wave 2
SMEs	"Eligible in seconds"	AED 300K at 5%; Mal pays your bills	Bank + Lender one-stop (vs FAB/WIO/EFG)	CFO Summit, Offline	"Upload paperwork"	Wave 1 USD Lending Wave 2

4 DISTRIBUTION, EVENTS & WAITLIST PLAYBOOK

DISTRIBUTION & PARTNERSHIPS

AREA	STATUS
Sales & marketing framework	NOT ESTABLISHED
Clients ≠ Partners (ADNOC = client)	PRINCIPLE
Custom approach per partner	REQUIRED
Pipeline: CFO conf + direct network	IN PROGRESS
McKinsey papers / amplification	TO EXPLORE
Offline SME onboarding (Isham)	ASSIGNED

"What is the biggest gap Mal fills for this partner?" Custom per client. Aldar = bad example.

Competitive Stack: FAB = large SMEs, no lending. WIO = tiny SMEs. EFG = lender not bank. **Mal = Bank + Lender. One-stop. Retail + SME.**

CFO SUMMIT & LAUNCH EVENT

CFO Summit (Q4 2025)

- ▶ Top CFOs in ME, 50 max, private round table
- ▶ 2-3 VIP speakers (e.g., Hazem)
- ▶ "Where are issues with your bank?"
- ▶ Capture: company info, employees, distro channel
- ▶ "Mal pays your bills — onboard your vendors"

Media Training Required

Amine David VK Zigor Maen+Walid Yousef Salem

2nd line: Talga, Rideu, Izz

WAITLIST HYPE PLAYBOOK

Paid Thought-Leader Strategy

- ▶ 10-20 LI thought-leaders (paid)
- ▶ Themes: UI, Shariah, speed, referrals
- ▶ "Credit limit in 30s, once licensed they'll kill it"
- ▶ CTA: "I have 5 slots to give"
- ▶ Share to LI/IG/X → get \$X free
- ▶ Benchmarks: Revolut, Clubhouse

4 Hype Pillars

This is what Mal is	Mal looks legit
Positive tech feedback	Speed & process

Rule: Only flex successful experiences. Be quantitative.

5 BRAND, SOCIAL WEB & GUARDRAILS

BRAND DNA & OWNED MEDIA (TO DEFINE BY AUG 2025)

Brand Foundation

- ▶ Tone of Voice (TOV)
- ▶ Brand Architecture
- ▶ Targets (NOT personas — serve everyone)
- ▶ Communication Style
- ▶ Assets: decks, attire, gifting
- ▶ Internal AI-agents for corp comms

Budget 20% split: PR, influencers, events. Minimum dollar spend. Benchmark Revolut, beat WIO.

Owned Media Map

- ▶ LinkedIn (primary), IG, X
- ▶ 10-20 paid LI thought-leaders
- ▶ Events: CFO Summit, Launch, sponsorships
- ▶ PR coverage strategy
- ▶ McKinsey / partnership ecosystem
- ▶ Private community (beta forum)

GUARDRAILS & PRINCIPLES

RULE	RATIONALE
Clients ≠ Partners	Closes doors (ADNOC = client)
No generic claims	"Faster, nicer" = noise. Be quantitative
Mal (global) ≠ Mal Bank (UAE)	CBUAE only cares about UAE
No user personas	Targets, not personas
Every \$ → growth metric	Min 20% contribution always
Only flex real experiences	"Transferred in 2 seconds" not "we're fast"
ACH = convenience	"Never need SWIFT again"
90% revenue = lending	All products acquire → retain, lending generates

WAITLIST USER FUNNEL

Email Only — Weak intent

Email + KYC — Interest

KYC + Referrals — Engagement

Loan Complete — IDEAL (full financial data)

Waitlist depth per product → determines timeline priorities

6 IMMEDIATE ACTION ITEMS

#	OWNER(S)	ACTION	DEADLINE	PRIORITY	STATUS
1	AAS + Walid	Draft exact timeline dates — one-pager roadmap + product suite sign-off	Jun 2025	URGENT	PENDING
2	Manar + Yasmeen + Isham	Brainstorm marketing strategy, roles & incentive strategy	Jun 2025	URGENT	PENDING
3	Manar + Yasmeen + Isham	Brainstorm CFO Summit + Launch Event (Oct 10 / Nov 11)	Jul 2025	URGENT	PENDING
4	Marketing Team	Brand DNA: TOV, architecture, comms style — finalize before waitlist hype	Aug 2025	URGENT	PENDING
5	Marketing Team	ID + contract 10-20 LI thought-leaders for paid hype campaign	Jul 2025	HIGH	PENDING
6	Marketing Team	Design waitlist referral package (share to LI/IG/X → \$X reward)	Jul 2025	HIGH	PENDING
7	Manar	Budget allocations: marketing, brand, sales, growth (Mukund input)	Jul 2025	HIGH	PENDING
8	Manar + Walid	Meet Global Accounts → schedule demos with all product leads	Jul 2025	HIGH	PENDING
9	Yasmeen / Isham	Media training program for CFO Summit speakers (6 primary + 3 secondary)	Aug 2025	HIGH	PENDING
10	Mukund	Develop growth budget request strategy (budget currently with Amine)	Jul 2025	MEDIUM	PENDING
11	Walid	Draft marketing roadmap document for full team alignment	Jul 2025	MEDIUM	PENDING
12	Sama / Amine	Hiring plan for marketing team (Sama = hiring, Amine = budget)	Aug 2025	MEDIUM	PENDING

CRITICAL PATH

Brand DNA (Aug '25) → License (Sep '25) → Launch Event (Oct '25) → Waitlist Hype (Oct '25–Jun '26) → Wave 1 Live (Jul '26) → Lending (Oct '26) → AI Agents (2027)

25 products | 4 launch waves | 18 markets
Prepared for internal leadership review